

HS 558: Science Fiction

Course Code: HS 558

Course Name: Science Fiction

L-T-P-C: 3-0-0-3

Prerequisites: None

Intended for: UG/PG

Mutual Exclusion: None

Approval: 60th BoA

Preamble

The course focusses on the genre of Science Fiction. In this course students study stories and novels based on various futuristic concepts of Science. They read, analyse and discuss stories in class. The readings include classics of Science fiction by HG Wells as well as short stories taken from the suggested text books for an understanding of how Science is imaginatively used to suggest, direct, and warn humanity of its dangers as well as the advantages.

Course Modules with Quantitative Lecture Hours

- **Unit 1: Introduction:** (6 Hours)

- Science Fiction as a Genre
- Science in Science Fiction

- **Unit 2: Time Travel:** (10 Hours)

- Past and Future
- Interacting with Many Worlds
- Time Dilation

Texts: HG Wells' *The Time Machine* (1895). "All You Zombies" (1959). "Forever Yours Anna" (1987).

- **Unit 3: Alien Encounters:** (6 Hours)

- Life in Other Worlds
- Imaginary Worlds and Real Worlds
- First Contact

Texts: "Shamblau" (1933), "A Martian Odyssey" (1934), "The Sentinel" (1951) and SLB's *Yana*. 2021.

- **Unit 4: Apocalypse and Post Apocalypse:** (6 Hours)

- Dystopia
- The New Age Life
- Hopelessness

Texts: "Coming Attraction" (1950), "Speech Sounds" (1983),

- **Unit 5: Artificial/Posthuman Life-forms:** (6 Hours)

- “Science in the Nineteenth Century”
- The New Life forms

Texts: “Rapaccini’s Daughter” (1844), “Exhalation” (2008) Edmond Hamilton’s “The Man Who Evolved.”

• **Unit 6: Computers and Virtual Reality:** (8 Hours)

- Replacing Human Efficiency
- The New Language of Society
- Human-Machine Interactions

Texts: “We Can Remember it for You Wholesale”, “Burning Chrome”, “Computer Friendly”

Primary Reference Books

1. Evans, Arthur B. Istavan Csicsery-Ronary Jr et al (eds). *The Wesleyan Anthology of Science Fiction*. Connecticut, Wesleyan University Press, 2010.
2. Silverberg, Robert. (1970.) *The Science Fiction Hall of Fame. Vol I, 1929-1964*. NY: A Tom Doherty Association Book, 1998.
3. Wells, H.G. (1895) *The Time Machine*. New Delhi: Fingerprint Publishing, 2015.
4. Bhyappa, SL. *Yana*. Bangalore: Subbu Books, 2021.

References

1. Bhyappa, SL. *Yana*. Bangalore: Subbu Books, 2021.
2. Evans, Arthur B. Istavan Csicsery-Ronary Jr et al (eds). *The Wesleyan Anthology of Science Fiction*. Connecticut, Wesleyan University Press, 2010.
3. Narlikar, Jayant. *The Return of Vamana*. New Delhi: Springer International Publishing, 2015.
4. Silverberg, Robert. (1970.) *The Science Fiction Hall of Fame. Vol I, 1929-1964*. NY: A Tom Doherty Association Book, 1998.
5. Wells, H.G. (1895) *The Time Machine*. New Delhi: Fingerprint Publishing, 2015.